Interview 1 Script

Andres Romero, Randal Guzman, Esteban Navar, Carlos Adrian Yanez Duron

Goal: learn how people use their car manufacturer's app for maintenance, and where it falls short.

Screener:

- Which car brand do you own, and which manufacturer app do you use?
  Owns a Hyundai Elantra. Uses the myHyundai app.
- How long have you used the app?
  Used the app for one year with a free trial

Opening (1 min):

- We tell them it's a class project about car maintenance apps.
- Say there are no right or wrong answers.
- Ask permission to take notes.

Part 1: How They Use It (3 min):

1. Walk me through the last time you opened the app. What were you trying to do?
   I was just trying to remotely start my car.
2. What do you mainly use it for?
   Just the remote starting mainly, I didn't use the other features too often.
3. How often do you open it in a typical month?
   I usually opened it twice a day.
4. Does it cost anything to use it?
   I had a year free trail, but it would cost maybe 80 a year.
5. Did you try anything else before this?
   I had a Ford, so I used the Ford app which was free.

Part 2: Maintenance Features (5 min):

6. Does the app tell you when maintenance is due? How (notification, email, text)?
   Yes, but I think you would have to check yourself. There were also no available appointments when I checked.
7. Has it ever reminded you too late, too often, or not at all?
   I don't think it would remind, just recommended off mileage.
8. Can you see your past service history in the app? Is it complete? (Does it include work done at other shops or by you?)
   Yes, but it only shows work done at the dealership. It also doesn’t show the cost.
9. Do you track what you spend on your car anywhere? Is it in this app?

No I don’t

Part 3: Gaps and Frustrations (3 min):

10. What is the most annoying or missing thing about the app?
    The appointment setting never worked so you had to call anyway to make an appointment.
11. What do you do when the app can't help (calendar, notes, receipts, asking the dealer)?
    Call for appointments
12. If you bought a car from a different brand, or owned two brands, what would you do with your records?
    Just store everything like the maintenance receipts in the glovebox.

Closing (2 min):

13. If you could add one feature to the app, what would it be?
    Something to track how much you’ve spent on maintenance.
14. What would make you leave this app?
    The charge is what made me leave the app.

Teardown:

The myHyundai app has many features, some related to our project and some not. Remote start/stop, door controls and the Bluelink features are out of scope. They also require an active Bluelink subscription, however, the app is free to download. The related features are a Car Care page, where you can see vehicle health and maintenance information, and a monthly vehicle health report. You can also see tire pressure, view recall status, and make a Car Care service appointment. The app tells you how many miles until your next service is due and shows service history (only for dealership work). The Hyundai app can read vehicle data directly from the car. Our app will be universal, allow you to log services from any shop, and give you the option to log costs as well.

Interview 2 Script

Screener:

- Which car brand do you own, and which manufacturer app do you use?
  Toyota
- How long have you used the app?
  A year

Opening (1 min):

- We tell them it's a class project about car maintenance apps.
- Say there are no right or wrong answers.

- Ask permission to take notes.

Part 1: How They Use It (3 min):

1. What do you mainly use it for?
   Checking my parking location
2. How often do you open it in a typical month?
   Just used it a couple of times. 2-3 times in a year
3. Does it cost anything to use it?
   No, but it does have paid services/features
4. Did you try anything else before this?
   Just this one

Part 2: Maintenance Features (5 min):

5. Does the app tell you when maintenance is due? How (notification, email, text)?
   Not sure, I didn't use it for that.
6. Think of a time it reminded you of something. What did you do next?
   Not used for reminders
7. Can you see your past service history in the app? Is it complete? (Does it include work done at other shops or by you?)
   I think so, but only for work at the dealership.
8. Do you track what you spend on your car anywhere? Is it in this app?
   No, not in general or with the app.

Part 3: Gaps and Frustrations (3 min):

9. What is the most annoying or missing thing about the app?
   Paid features are annoying
10. What do you do when the app can't help (calendar, notes, receipts, asking the dealer)?
    Search for another app or another solution/service. I used the notes app to keep track, but it would be cool to have it all in one.
11. If you bought a car from a different brand, or owned two brands, what would you do with your records?
    Keep everything in a folder/spreadsheet.

Closing (2 min):

12. If you could add one feature to the app, what would it be?
    Keep all your receipts/notes about your car/services (cost) in one place.
13. What would make you leave this app?
    A better app with more features and free services.

Teardown:

The Toyota app has features related and unrelated to our project. Remote Connect (remote start and lock) is out of scope. The related features are a Vehicle Health Report (recalls, warnings, maintenance info) and a Vehicle Diagnostic Data card. There are also maintenance reminders by email, in the app, or through your My Toyota account. There is an opt-in Vehicle Maintenance Alert that notifies you and your preferred dealer. You can schedule a service and view your service history (only for dealership work). Service Connect needs an active trial or paid subscription, and the app supports 2010 and newer models. Our app will be universal, allow you to log services from any shop, and give you the option to log costs as well.

Interview 3 Script

Screener:

- Which car brand do you own, and which manufacturer app do you use?
  Owns a Nissan and uses the MyNissanApp
- How long have you used the app?
  Approximately 2 years

Opening (1 min):

- We tell them it's a class project about car maintenance apps.
- Say there are no right or wrong answers.
- Ask permission to take notes.

Part 1: How They Use It (3 min):

1. Walk me through the last time you opened the app. What were you trying to do?
   Last time he opened the app was about 4 months ago. He was checking to see if his car was due for an oil change
2. What do you mainly use it for?
   Mainly uses it to keep track of his oil changes
3. How often do you open it in a typical month?
   Roughly about 2 times a month
4. Does it cost anything to use it?
   It does not have a cost
5. Did you try anything else before this?
   This is the first time he uses an app like this

Part 2: Maintenance Features (5 min):

6. Does the app tell you when maintenance is due? How (notification, email, text)?
   The app is a bit confusing to use. It does keep track of maintenance. He does not know if you can or can not set up reminders as he has a hard time using the app
7. Think of a time it reminded you of something. What did you do next?

Last time it gave him a reminder; it was for an oil change. He checked to see if his car was actually due for an oil change

8. Has it ever reminded you too late, too often, or not at all?

   No he doesn't recall a time where it notified him too late or anything

9. Can you see your past service history in the app? Is it complete? (Does it include work done at other shops or by you?)

   He can only see it if he manually logs it. It can include the shops but he has to manually logs it into his app

10. Do you track what you spend on your car anywhere? Is it in this app?

    He does not track what he spends on his car

Part 3: Gaps and Frustrations (3 min):

11. What is the most annoying or missing thing about the app?

    The Most frustrating thing about the app is the confusing aspect of navigating through it. He wishes it was more straight forward.

12. What do you do when the app can't help (calendar, notes, receipts, asking the dealer)?

    When the app can not help with personal stuff he writes them down in his notepad

13. If you bought a car from a different brand, or owned two brands, what would you do with your records?

    "I guess I would throw them away"

Closing (2 min):

14. If you could add one feature to the app, what would it be?

    He wishes he could log every time he put gas that way it could keep track of how much he spends

15. What would make you leave this app?

    What would make him leave the app is if he got a new car.

Teardown:

The Nissan app, named myNissan, has multiple features, some related and some non-related to our project. For example, you can remotely start/stop the vehicle, lock/unlock the doors, and control the a/c, all of which are out of scope for our project. The app also has a vehicle health feature where you can see information such as warning lights and tire pressure. You can also see when your next oil change is due, schedule a service on the app, view upcoming appointments, and view your service history (only for dealership service). The Nissan app has the advantage of being able to automatically update mileage and show warning lights, while our app will be universal, allow you to log services from any shop, and give you the option to log costs as well.

Field Notes:

Evidence Id	*Interview*	*Interview Evidence*	*Tag*

E-01	Hyundai	Used the app mainly for remote starting, approximately twice a day.	Behavior
E-02	Hyundai	Previously used the Ford app, which was free.	Behavior
E-03	Hyundai	Checked appointment availability but found no available appointments.	Behavior
E-04	Hyundai	Called to schedule appointments because the app's booking feature did not work.	Behavior
E-05	Hyundai	Does not track vehicle maintenance expenses.	Behavior
E-06	Hyundai	Stopped using the app because of the subscription charge.	Behavior
E-07	Hyundai	Would store maintenance receipts in the glovebox if switching vehicle brands.	Opinion
E-08	Hyundai	Wants a feature to track maintenance expenses.	Opinion
E-09	Toyota	Used the app to check the vehicle's parking location, approximately 2-3 times a year.	Behavior
E-10	Toyota	Did not use the app for maintenance reminders.	Behavior
E-11	Toyota	Does not track vehicle maintenance spending.	Behavior
E-12	Toyota	Used the Notes app to keep track of information.	Behavior
E-13	Toyota	Searches for other apps or solutions when the manufacturer app cannot help.	Behavior
E-14	Toyota	Finds paid feature annoying.	Opinion
E-15	Toyota	Would like receipts, notes, and maintenance costs in one place.	Opinion
E-16	Toyota	Would switch to a better app with more features and free services.	Opinion
E-17	Toyota	Would keep records in a folder or spreadsheet if switching brands.	Opinion
E-18	Nissan	Last opened the app approximately four months ago to check whether an oil change was due.	Behavior
E-19	Nissan	Mainly uses the app to track oil changes.	Behavior
E-20	Nissan	Received an oil-change reminder and checked whether maintenance was due.	Behavior

E-21	Nissan	Manually logs service history to keep records in the app.	Behavior
E-22	Nissan	Does not track vehicle expenses.	Behavior
E-23	Nissan	Writes information in a notepad when the app cannot help.	Behavior
E-24	Nissan	Finds the app confusing and difficult to navigate.	Opinion
E-25	Nissan	Wants a simpler, more straightforward app.	Opinion
E-26	Nissan	Wishes the app could track gasoline expenses.	Opinion
E-27	Nissan	Would stop using the app if they purchased another vehicle.	Opinion

Evidence Log:

ID	*Source*	*Tier*	*Date*	*What it is*	*Evidence IDs*
I-01	Interview: Hyundai owner (former myHyundai user, 1 year)	1	10/13	15-min interview	E-01 to E-08
I-02	Interview: Toyota owner (current Toyota app user, 1 year)	1	10/13	15-min interview	E-09 to E-17
I-03	Interview: Nissan owner (current myNissan user, ~2 years)	1	10/15	15-min interview	E-18 to E-27
T-01	Teardown: myNissan	1	10/19	30-min hands-on, own account.	N/A
T-02	Teardown: myHyundai with Bluelink	1	10/19	30-min hands-on, own account.	N/A
T-03	Teardown: Toyota app	1	10/19	30-min hands-on, own account.	N/A

Competitive Landscape:

Map:

	Direct	*Indirect*	*Status quo*
Who	myHyundai, Toyota app, myNissan (manufacturer apps)	Calling the dealer to book and track service (E-04)	Notes app (E-12), notepad (E-23), glovebox receipts (E-07), folder or spreadsheet (E-17)

	Direct	*Indirect*	*Status quo*
How we found it	Interviews + teardowns	Interview last-time stories	Interview workarounds ("I just...")
Assumption each makes	Owners will be satisfied with the manufacturer's app for maintenance	Owners prefer a human at the dealer for service	Owners will keep using free tools because staying costs nothing
Evidence	E-03, E-04, E-21	E-04	E-05, E-11, E-22 (none track spending)

Comparison Table:

Field	*Brand 1*	*Brand 2*	*Brand 3*
Manufacturer / app	myHyundai	Toyota	MyNissanApp
How long they've used it	(former user) 1 year	1 year	2 years
Maintenance reminders? (yes/no)	yes	yes	Yes
Service history complete? (yes/no)	no	no	no
Tracks spending there? (yes/no)	no	no	no
Biggest frustration	Appointment feature	Paid features	How confusing it is (not very user friendly)
Workaround they use	Call for help.	Search for other solutions.	Searches for other solutions

Ranked Switching Triggers:

Rank	*Trigger*	*Support*
1	No way to see what they spend on the car, in one place	Nobody tracks spending (E-05, E-11, E-22); all three wished for some tracking or one place (E-08, E-15, E-26)
2	Paid subscription or paid features	E-06, E-14, E-16
3	App only covers dealership work or broken features	E-04
4	Confusing to use	E-24, E-25
5	Getting a new car (brand change)	E-27

Change Note:

Field	*Team to complete*
What changed in the business case	Add fuel (gas) logging to the app scope.
Evidence IDs that support it	E-26
Why	Our app already includes maintenance cost logging, and we just got evidence of another type of cost logging that a user would like to have. Adding this makes our logging feature more complete.
What it affects downstream	Charter scope boundary, story points and hours

Candidate Risk Entries:

R-01 Status quo: users keep their notes, receipts and spreadsheets

Field	*Entry*
Risk	Owners keep using free habits (Notes app, notepad, glovebox, spreadsheet) instead of adopting our app.
Trigger	People say they are comfortable using what they use now.
Proposed owner	Product lead
Mitigation	Make logging one tap/simple.
Evidence IDs	E-05, E-07, E-11, E-12, E-17, E-22, E-23

R-02 Manufacturer apps close the gap

Field	*Entry*
Risk	Manufacturer apps add cost tracking or other-shop logging, which weakens our value.
Trigger	Any of the three apps mention cost tracking or non-dealer service entry.
Proposed owner	Market Research lead
Mitigation	Stay universal across brands and keep cost and fuel tracking central.
Evidence IDs	E-21, E-08, E-15, E-26

R-03 Price sensitivity

Field	*Entry*
Risk	Users drop apps that charge, so any fee for our app could stop adoption.
Trigger	Many users say price or a paid feature would make them leave.

Field	*Entry*
Proposed owner	Project Manager
Mitigation	Keep core logging free.
Evidence IDs	E-02, E-06, E-14, E-16

Contradiction Memo:

Assumption: Many drivers would use an app for maintenance tracking and reminders
Contradiction: 2 out of the 3 interviewees said that they don't use their manufacturer apps for maintenance reasons. (E-01 and E-10)
Advice: Earlier interviews indicate people do want a solution, we just have to make sure they will use it.